

questions, unless you ask it to. GA is tuned to work the way you want it to work. So if you want specific answers, you will have to create specific goals.

What Are Goals?

“Goals measure how well your site or app fulfills your target objectives. A goal represents a completed activity, called a conversion, that contributes to the success of your business”, defines Google. Put simply, a goal is how you can measure the number of times that someone has completed a specific action on your site. And every time that someone completes that action, you know that a conversion has occurred. The ideal way to measure the frequency of these conversions is through the conversion rate of your site. You calculate the conversion rate basis the percentage of site visitors who have completed a goal as specified by you.

Why Do You Need Goals and Conversions?

Goals will help you measure and even compare metrics that can be useful for your business. Yes, keeping tabs on metrics such as average session duration, pageviews as well as bounce rates can help you understand what is working for your visitors, but unless you are a business that is focused on generating revenues from ads, these metrics will not be the only ones that matter. If you learn how to set up Goals and use them to your advantage, you can measure metrics such as the number of clicks that have occurred on your CTAs (Call to actions), the number of sales completed or the number of leads generated.

Goals can help you track a number of more metrics in comparison to the reports that you see by default on GA, but it also makes it incredibly easier to analyze, report on (to seniors in the company or your clients) as well as optimize your site to eventually lead to more conversions. If you have properly set up Goals, you will be able to use GA's default reports to see which one of your channels are providing you with the highest conversion rates. This information can be used to determine if the traffic that you are seeing from all of the other channels is also effective or not. Once you have Goals set up, you will be able to find out how much each of your pages or channels is contributing to the bottom line of your business. This will also make it easier to figure out the ROI on various of your campaigns. The best part for those looking for reports is that when you implement Goals, it will open you up to a whole new section of reports in GA - attribution modeling, deeper segmentation, funnel analysis, etc. Long story short, Goals